2025

(CBCS)

(5th Semester)

ENGLISH

EIGHTH (B) PAPER

(Popular Studies)

Full Marks : 75

Time : 3 hours

The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions

(SECTION : A—OBJECTIVE)

(*Marks* : 10)

Tick (✓) the correct answer in the brackets provided : 1×10=10

1. Mars Bonfire wrote the song "Born to be Wild" for his brother's band

(a) Steppenwolf ( )
(b) Pink Floyd ( )
(c) The Scorpions ( )
(d) Metallica ( )

2. "The Sound of Silence" first appeared in 1964 in the album

(a) *The Sound of Silence* ( )
(b) *Wednesday Morning, 3 AM* ( )
(c) *New York City* ( )
(d) *Simon and Garfunkel* ( )

3. "No one told you when to run, you missed the _____"

(a) rising sun ( )
(b) starting gun ( )
(c) summer fun ( )
(d) scary nun ( )

4. The song "Imagine" was inspired by

(a) the assassination of John F. Kennedy ( )
(b) a poster of a car ( )
(c) the Civil Rights Movement ( )
(d) a book of poems by Yoko Ono ( )

5. In *The Inscrutable Americans*, Gopal Kumar is the son of a

(a) successful soap maker ( )

(b) hair oil tycoon ( )

(c) car reseller ( )

(d) cobbler ( )

6. What is Andy's real name in *The Inscrutable Americans* ?

(a) Andrew ( )

(b) Peacock ( )

(c) Anand ( )

(d) Anurag ( )

7. In *Second Thoughts*, Maya is originally from

(a) Kanpur ( )

(b) Delhi ( )

(c) Bombay ( )

(d) Calcutta ( )

8. Nikhil in *Second Thoughts* has a degree from a university in

(a) UK ( )

(b) America ( )

(c) Switzerland ( )

(d) Norway ( )

9. *One Night at the Call Centre* is narrated from _____ point of view.

(a) Chetan Bhagat's ( )

(b) the girl on the train's ( )

(c) God's ( )

(d) Shyam Mehra's ( )

10. The train journey in *One Night at the Call Centre* goes from

(a) Nagpur to Delhi ( )

(b) Kanpur to Delhi ( )

(c) Mumbai to Delhi ( )

(d) Jaipur to Delhi ( )

(SECTION : B—SHORT ANSWERS)

(*Marks* : 15)

Answer the following : 3×5=15

UNIT—I

1. Why does the speaker liken silence to cancer in "The Sound of Silence"?

OR

2. What does Mars Bonfire mean by the line "Fire all of your guns at once" ?

UNIT—II

3. Under what circumstances did McCartney compose the song "Let it Be"?

OR

4. Explain the following lines :

"The time is gone, the song is over, thought I'd something more to say"

UNIT—III

5. What oath does Gopal's grandmother ask him to take? Does he fulfil his oath?

OR

6. Who is Randy in *The Inscrutable Americans*?

UNIT—IV

7. Give a brief description of Ranjan's character in *Second Thoughts*.

OR

8. What did Maya do to cope with her loneliness in *Second Thoughts* ?

UNIT—V

9. Why did Radhika leave her husband in *One Night at the Call Centre* ?

OR

10. Briefly describe the conversation with God in *One Night at the Call Centre*.

(SECTION : C—DESCRIPTIVE)

(*Marks* : 50)

Answer the following : 10×5=50

UNIT—I

1. What were the factors that contributed to the rise of the countercultural movement in America during the 1960s?

OR

2. Critically analyze Bob Dylan's "Blowin' in the Wind".

UNIT—II

3. Describe John Lennon's ideal for a united world as seen in the song "Imagine".

OR

4. Describe how Roger Waters explored the concept of time in his song "Time".

UNIT—III

5. Discuss the elements of humour in *The Inscrutable Americans.*

OR

6. Comment on the cultural shock experienced by Gopal in *The Inscrutable Americans.*

UNIT—IV

7. Analyze Shobhaa De's *Second Thoughts* as a novel highlighting the evils of the patriarchal system in Indian society.

OR

8. Discuss the breakdown of the Indian marital system in *Second Thoughts.*

UNIT—V

9. How does Chetan Bhagat explore the problems faced by Indian youths in *One Night at the Call Centre* ?

OR

10. How does Chetan Bhagat highlight and resolve the clash between tradition and modernity in *One Night at the Call Centre* ?

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